20th century, the migrations were wide-ranging, affecting a variety of castes as observed by the district gazetteer of 1938:[10]

> The emigrants are labourers, mostly men who are recruited for the plantations in Coorg and Mysore territory, but they return to their native villages every year when the crop is harvested. There is of course the usual emigration of the professional and middle-classes in search for employment in other parts of India, besides a considerable number of 'Udupi' Brahmin cooks who are to be found employed in households or engaged in running restaurants outside their own native district.

What were Brahmins doing as cooks and why did they start migrating in large numbers to run restaurants? Udupi is known in religious circles for its famous Sri Krishna Temple, founded after Madhvacharya in the 13th century. To propagate his philosophy of *Dvaita Vedanta,* eight *matha*s or monasteries were set up, and over time a vibrant temple culture took root in nearby places. Brahmins came to comprise 10 per cent of the region's population, three times higher than elsewhere in south India.[11] The temple culture manifested itself in periodic ceremonies where food was served to big gatherings of the temple staff and pilgrims.[12] It was in this setting that K. Krishna Rao, the son of a Hindu priest and founder of the Woodlands group of hotels, began his career in food service as an attendant. In 1922, family squabbles led him to move to Chennai where he worked his way up the ladder in the food business and started his own Udupi Sri Krishna Vilas within a few years. The 1920s proved to be a watershed moment in Udupi's migration history as a major flood devastated the region in 1923.[13] Mass migration of male workers and professionals to large cities led to the rising demand for low-cost public eating spaces. Several prominent Udupi food outlets such as Dasaprakash in Mysore and Udupi Sri Krishna Bhavan and Mavalli Tiffin Rooms (MTR) in Bangalore were set up in the 1920s to cater to this demand. These public eating spaces were famous for being 'pure vegetarian', employed middle to upper caste folk from the Udupi region and, in the initial decades, had segregated seating spaces on caste lines. Migration from Udupi was unique in that it involved a considerable number of child migrants in search of work and the key destination—the restaurant—provided free food and accommodation.[14] This led to substantial cost